

anyone make changes without authorisation. The level of security can be changed from 'standard' for desktop users to 'high', 'higher' and 'paranoid', if the PC is going to be used as a server. You can tweak your desktop resolution and the colour depth but the changes will be effective only after a reboot. In the Control Center you can even check the list of hardware installed on the system. Clicking the 'Hardware list' button will indicate whether or not the device has been detected properly. The boot sequence can also be changed if you wish to log in as a different user and with a different Windows manager.

There are 16 desktops available, out of which four are on the screen by default. Other GUIs that come bundled with Mandrake 8.2 are GNOME, IceWM and Sawfish. These can be selected at the login screen.

'Psuedo Explorer'

KDE's Konqueror acts, feels and behaves just like Windows Explorer. It allows you to browse to the various folders and files and makes file management much simpler. The Konqueror interface also works as a Web browser and its configuration process is similar to how you would configure other Windows-based Web browsers. Konqueror functions as your one-stop interface for browsing through the network, the file system and the Internet. One can browse the

network by typing `smb://machinename` from within Konqueror itself.

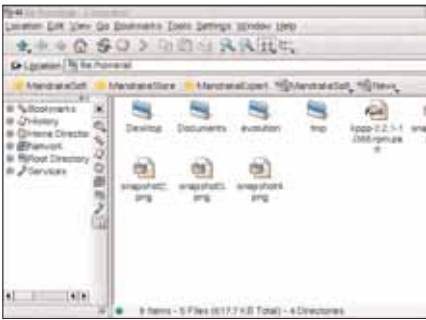
Bundled applications

The operating system comes standard with a few powerful applications such as XMMS 1.2.6 for playing and managing your MP3 music files. Mozilla 0.9.8 comes built-in. Though the 0.9.9 engine is out, this one is stable enough. GIMP 1.2.3, the all powerful image editing software, allows you to create and manipulate photos with ease. Gphoto2 gives you additional functionality to manage your digital photos, Grip 2.98 is your standard audio ripping software, KOffice 1.1.1 integrates all the necessary office applications and Gnomemeeting 0.84 is the fully featured video conferencing software.

Evolution 1.02 is the built-in mail client, and is very similar to Outlook. It's very easy to configure—just give the necessary incoming and outgoing mail server addresses. Supply the relevant e-mail address and passwords and you are done—it's as simple as configuring Microsoft's Outlook or Outlook Express.

Server side tools

In addition to desktop enhancements, Mandrake 8.2 also offers significant benefits when used as a server. Many new server applications and configuration utilities have now been integrated.



The Konqueror interface looks like Windows Explorer

The Enterprise Kernel 2.4.18 now provides native support for very high memory configurations (greater than 1024 MB) and has support for SMP (Symmetric Multi Processing). It also has support for file systems like Ext3, ReiserFS, XFS and JFS, as well as an encrypted file system to ensure data integrity. A special version of Samba combined with XFS and Samba 2.2.3 now allow Windows file sharing. Also available are a plethora of server side applications such as Apache 1.3.23, PHP 4.1.2, MySQL 3.23.47, PostgreSQL 7.2 and Sendmail 8.12.1.

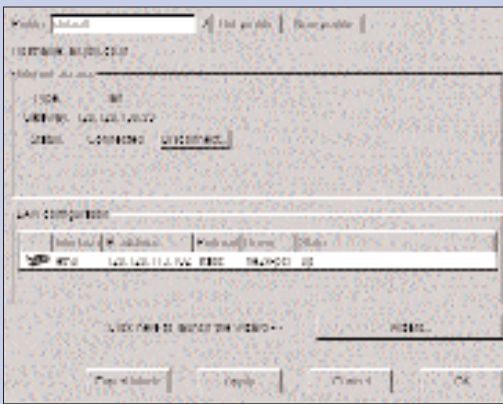
Wizards for easy configuration of the main server functions such as Firewall, File and Print sharing, etc have also been provided. Draknet, a network configuration tool, provides a simple way to set up Internet connection sharing. You can configure DNS, Samba, NFS, local/remote

Configuring the Network Card

One of the best things about Mandrake 8.2 is that it detects most of the hardware and doesn't ask for drivers. We tested Mandrake 8.2 on a system which had a Realtek RTL8029AS-based LAN card.

Click on the Control Center to configure the network card. You will be prompted for the root password. Now, click on the 'Network and Internet' tab, and then on 'Connection'. Here you can see the card as eth0 below the 'Interface' tab. Click on the 'Wizard' tab and select the profile. Leave the profile as default if you are configuring only the LAN card.

If you also want to configure a modem on the same machine, you will have to create two separate profiles. The next window that opens up will present you with five different options; here click on 'LAN connection'. When you select it, the small checkbox against this option becomes hollow, so don't get confused. Click 'Next'; this will bring up the 'Draknet' window,



On correct installation, the network card shows a 'Connected' status

showing the name of the network card installed and you will be prompted to install another network card. Click 'Yes' if you have two network cards on your system; click 'No' if only one card is installed. After the card is detected, 'Draknet' will

ask for the IP address and the Net-mask. You can get this information from your system administrator. The next step is to provide the DNS (domain name server) and gateway details along with the host name. In the subsequent windows, provide the HTTP/FTP proxy address, if there is one, and click 'Next'.

After you get a confirmation of successful configuration of the network card, click 'Finish'. To test whether or not the network is working, go to Control Center and click on 'Samba Mount Point'. In the next window, click on the 'Search Servers' tab.

The names of the machines on the network will be displayed on the left hand side. Try to mount any of the shared folders to ensure that your network card is working okay.

